Kiko Pan

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Experience

IBM February 2026 – Present

UX Designer

- Owned end-to-end design for 2 workflows in IBM Concert for Z, a B2B enterprise product, simplifying mainframe monitoring and issue investigation for operators.
- Accelerated prototyping with Figma Make and IBM Bob, iterating on and verifying AI-generated outputs before stakeholder review, reducing concept-to-review time by 30%.
- Partnered with UX Research to conduct 3 user-testing sessions with 6 banking participants, identifying 3 usability issues and driving 2 workflow improvements.
- Collaborated with PMs, developers, researchers, and designers to resolve technical constraints, refine user flows, and address edge cases before development.
- Applied the IBM Carbon Design System and prepared annotated Figma specifications for engineering handoff, supporting design reviews to ensure implementation fidelity.

Hawl Technologies October 2025 – January 2026

UI/UX Team Lead

- Led a 3-person design team building an AI-powered browser extension for managing conversations across multiple chat platforms, taking 2 core workflows from product definition through high-fidelity prototypes.
- Partnered with engineering and product stakeholders to evaluate technical feasibility, translate technical constraints into product and UX decisions, and iterate designs toward implementation.
- Created and tested high-fidelity prototypes, identifying 3 usability issues before development and reducing downstream design and engineering rework through early validation.
- Led design critiques, feedback cycles, and delivery planning, aligning product goals and user experience decisions across 3+ cross-functional stakeholders.

Miss Vietnam San Diego July 2024 – September 2024

Web Developer

- Collaborated with project managers, UX writers, and designers to translate ambiguous requirements into clear, actionable design goals.
- Delivered a responsive Vue.js website that improved accessibility and visibility while supporting community-focused objectives.
- Iterated on prototypes and design decisions based on usability feedback, improving navigation and adoption.

Girls Who Code May 2024 – August 2024

Teaching Assistant

- Co-led 2 four-week game design cohorts with 60+ students, achieving a 95% project completion rate through collaborative instruction and mentorship.
- Synthesized student feedback with 10+ educators to refine curriculum, increasing engagement scores by 25% and earning a 4.7/5 satisfaction rating.

Projects

Bloom Studio | *Product Designer & Researcher* February 2025 – March 2025

- Designed an interactive grocery store kiosk featuring real-time bouquet previews and smart suggestions, using insights from 8+ guerrilla interviews and 5+ user interviews to identify pain points in bouquet selection.

Project Art of Learning | *UI/UX Design Lead* January 2024 – June 2024

- Led a website redesign for a San Diego nonprofit, conducting 18 user interviews and usability tests to identify key pain points and opportunities.
- Translated research findings into actionable design improvements, increasing site navigation efficiency by 20%.

Snap-A-Tune | *Product Designer* April 2024 – June 2024

- Designed an AI-powered music discovery app using photo recognition to generate personalized playlists, validating demand through competitive analysis and usability testing with 15 participants; 85% expressed strong interest.

Skills

Design: Figma, Figma Make, Interaction Design, User Flows, Information Architecture, Wireframing, Prototyping, Design Systems, Design Specifications
AI & Development: Cursor, Claude Code, IBM Bob, AI-Assisted Prototyping, HTML/CSS, JavaScript, Vue.js, Python, Excel
Research: User Interviews, Usability Testing, Survey Design, Affinity Mapping, Competitive Analysis

Education

University of California, San Diego June 2025

B.S. Cognitive Science: Design + Interaction; Minor in Computer Science